GG-P-146a
June 25, 1956
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. GG–P–00146 (GSA–FSS)
Revision 1
March 30, 1955, and
Fed. Spec. GG–P–146
January 16, 1953

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PEN SETS, DESK (FOR GENERAL OFFICE USE)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope.—This specification covers desk pen sets of the dip and fountain pen type, consisting of one pen and base or reservoir, for general office use (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types and classes.*—The pen sets shall be of the following types and classes as specified in the invitation for bids (see 6.2):

Type I.—Dip type.
- Class 1.—With separate or inbuilt ink container without nonspill features.
- Class 2.—With inbuilt ink container with nonspill features.

Type II.—Fountain pen type.
- Class 1.—Conventional fountain pen.
- Class 2.—Ball point pen.

1.2.2 *Color.*—Color shall be as specified in the invitation for bids (see 6.2).

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards.—The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

TT–I–563—Ink, Writing, Blue-Black, for Fountain, Dip, and Steel Pens.
LLL–B–631 — Boxes; Fiber Corrugated (for Domestic Shipment).
LLL–B–636 — Boxes; Fiber Solid (for Domestic Shipment).
PPP–B–566 — Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP–B–676—Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.

Interim Federal Specification:

PPP–T–0060 (NAVY-AER)—Tape, Pressure Sensitive Adhesive for Packaging and Sealing.

Military Specifications:

JAN–P–108—Boxes; Fiberboard, Corrugated and Solid (Military Type).
MIL–B–4229—Boxes; Paperboard, Metal-Stayed.
MIL–L–10547 — Liners, Case, Waterproof.

Military Standards:

MIL–STD–105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL–STD–129 — Marking for Shipment and Storage.

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(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from the established distribution points in their agencies.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 **Other publication.** — Consolidated Freight Classification Rules, publication of the Consolidated Classification Committee, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, forms a part of this specification.

(Application for copies of the referenced publication should be addressed to the Consolidated Classification Committee, 202 Chicago Union Station, Chicago 6, Ill.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.—Materials shall be as specified hereinafter.

3.1.1 *Plastic.*—Plastic used in the pen sets shall be of the ink-proof, nonflammable, slow-burning, or slow-burning to self-extinguishing type. Cellulose nitrate-type plastic will not be acceptable. The plastic shall not be subject to attack or deterioration by acids in ink nor have any objectionable odor when in continuous contact with writing ink conforming to Federal Specification TT–I–563 (see 3.5.1.2 and 4.3.1).

3.1.2 *Glass, metal, bakelite, or durable ceramic* may be used for the base instead of plastic. All material shall be durable when exposed to extreme temperature changes and shall be heat treated to prevent molding stains. All light material bases shall be weighted so that the pen set will be sufficiently stable to resist slight jostling in normal use without upsetting and with little or no sliding from position on desk.

3.1.3 *Stainless steel.* — Unless otherwise specified, the point for pens of type I, classes 1 and 2, and type II, class 1, shall be made of ink-resistant and noncorrosive stainless steel, with a tip turned or treated which will resist wear and meet the writing qualities specified herein. Pen may be treated or plated in accordance with good commercial practice.

3.2 Design.—The pen sets shall be designed to operate efficiently on a continuous or intermittent basis and to meet the additional performance requirements specified herein. The pen point or pen point and ink-retaining feed shall be designed to fit snugly in the proper position in holder. Each pen set shall be constructed so as to allow satisfactory assembly and disassembly of all parts. (See 3.3, 3.4, and 3.5.)

3.3 Types I and II pen sets.—Each pen shall be provided with a base pad or feet which will not mar the desk top, having nonskid properties such as natural or synthetic rubber, or a combination of rubber and cork, or with a base pad of felt. Vacuum-type base pads or base pads with a "sticky" surface designed to adhere to the surface upon which the base is placed, will not be acceptable. The "nonskid" base pad shall provide the pen set with an apreciable resistance to lateral pressure and shall provide no resistance to vertical lift. All pens shall be of such design and material that they will have a formed finger grip and fit sockets snugly to inhibit evaporation of ink. Pen staffs shall not warp and parts shall not become loose at any temperature within the range of plus 30° to plus 120°F. (See 3.4 and 3.5.)

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3.3.1 *Dimensions.*

3.3.1.1 *Base.*—The dimensions of the base of all types shall not exceed 6 inches in length, 4½ inches in width, and 4 inches in height, unless otherwise specified in the invitation for bids.

3.3.1.2 *Pen.* — The over-all length of all types of pens shall fall within the range of 5¾ and 7½ inches, including the nib.

3.3.2 *Finish.*—The pen sets shall be finished in accordance with standard commercial practice.

3.3.3 *Identification marking.* — Unless otherwise specified, the manufacturer's name or trademark shall appear in a suitable position. When specified, the legend "U. S. Government" shall appear in a prominent position. Each pen point shall be marked to indicate grading, such as "fine", "medium", etc., by the manufacturer's part number or grading, or the barrel of each pen shall be plainly marked with a sticker to identify the grading of the pen point furnished therewith. (See 3.6.)

3.4 **Type I.** (See 3.3.)

3.4.1 *Component parts.*—Type I pen sets shall consist of a base with an ink reservoir in a dip well to support the pen-staff and to ink the pen point and the ink-retaining feed behind the point.

3.4.1.1 *Base.*—Type I base shall be of stable construction having a separate or inbuilt refillable-type ink container. The separate type container shall have a stopper or a strap, or other adequate means of retention of the ink container. The socket of the base shall be designed to hold the pen firmly at an angle between 45° and 70° from the horizontal. Type I, class 2 shall be spill-proof when inverted. (See 3.1.2.)

3.4.1.2 *Reservoir.*—Type I shall have an expansion chamber and reservoir constructed so that (*a*) the feed and point section of the pen remains in the ink to a level of approximately ⅜ inch from the end of the writing point, or (*b*) the feed and point section of the pen rests against the small opening in the ink channel through which the ink flows from the main ink reservoir; thus at all times supplying the feed and point section of the pen by means of capillary action with just the right amount of ink from the main ink reservoir. The capacity of the reservoir of type I shall be one or more ounces.

3.4.2 *Design and performance.*—Type I pen sets shall be designed so as to permit a minimum of evaporation and allow a controlled ink level at the base. Each set shall be constructed so that it will efficiently use approximately 75 percent of the ink that it contains when filled to the proper level. The base shall be designed so that it can be cleaned without the use of special tools and refilled. The pen set shall be constructed so as to keep the finger grip of penholder clean in normal use and in a 40°F. temperature rise. Ink feeding shall be of the self-feeding type which permits continuous writing with infrequent dipping. Pen points shall not drip ink. Pen sets shall operate efficiently under any temperature within the range of plus 30° to plus 120°F. The desk sets shall operate efficiently without spillage or overflow with a rise or fall in temperature of 40°F. in 2 hours when the reservoir is not more than 20 percent filled. (See 3.2 and 3.6.)

3.5 **Type II.** (See 3.3.)

3.5.1. *Component parts.*—Type II pen sets shall consist of a base with a socket designed to hold the pen and penholder with a minimum of evaporation for class 1 conventional fountain pen and the class 2 ball point pen.

3.5.1.1 *Base.* — Type II base shall be of stable construction with a socket which will hold the pen firmly. The socket shall be attached to the base and hold the pen firmly at an angle between 45° and 70° from the horizontal or may be hinged to allow a variable angle. (See 3.1.2.)

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3.5.1.2 *Pen.*—Type II, class 1 pen shall have an efficient self-filling mechanism of the lever type with a double-action presser bar, or the equivalent of such lever type as specified in the invitation for bids. Type II, class 2 pen shall have a replaceable ink cartridge, which contains a permanent quick-drying, non-smear, non-transferable type ink, which is available on the commercial market. The ink shall not be affected by the container, or the container by the ink (certificate from an accredited laboratory shall be furnished with each bid to support this requirement). Cartridge shall contain at least 0.40 milliliter of ink and shall be leak-proof and simple to install. The cartridge shall remain in a condition to give satisfactory writing results within one year from date of shipment under normal storage conditions.

3.5.2 *Performance.*—Type II pens shall not drip ink. Each pen set shall be constructed so that the finger grip of the pen remains clean in normal use and in a 40°F. temperature rise and fall. Pens shall operate efficiently under any temperature within the range of plus 30°F. to plus 120° F.

3.6 **Pen points.**—Pen points shall be furnished as specified in the manufacturer's "fine", "medium", and "broad" grading, which represents the limits of written line generally accepted in the commercial field. Other designations such as "extra fine" and "stub" may be specifically called for in the invitation for bids. Point slits shall be centered with even width of point on each side. Slits shall be set with sufficient opening to permit ink flow but not so wide as to stop capillary action. Points shall be parallel, not one up and one down. Each pen point shall be so finished and polished or ground that it will write smoothly in all directions when the pen is held at the normal writing angle, and that it will not pick up particles of paper nor dig into the paper under normal writing conditions. Unless otherwise specified, type I, classes 1 and 2, and type II, class 1 desk sets shall have pens with "medium" points (see 3.3.3).

3.7 **Workmanship.**—The pen sets, including all component parts, shall be free from burrs and sharp or rough edges, and other defects which affect the appearance or which might affect the serviceability. Mating of parts shall be sufficiently accurate for the purpose intended and in keeping with the best commercial practice. Particular attention shall be given to concentricity and formation of parts, fits and threaded parts, accuracy of dimensions, and marking of parts and assemblies.

3.8 **Interchangeability.**—All parts having the same manufacturer's part number shall be interchangeable with each other with respect to installation and performance. Changes in manufacturer's part numbers shall be made if the design is changed and interchangeability is affected.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling for lot acceptance.

4.1.1 *Inspection lot.*—All pen sets of the same type and class presented at one time shall be considered a lot for purposes of inspection and tests.

4.1.2 *Sampling for visual and dimensional inspection.*—A random sample of pen sets shall be taken from each inspection lot of materials offered for Government inspection of visual and dimensional characteristics, with lot acceptance based on the following single sampling inspection requirements (table I) in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105:

4.1.3 *Sampling for tests.* — Two sample pen sets shall be taken at random from the lot (4.1.1) for test purposes.

4.2 **Inspection.**—Each of the sample pen sets taken in accordance with table I shall be visually and dimensionally inspected by the Government inspector to determine compliance with the requirements of this specification. Any pen set in the sample containing

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one or more visual defects shall be rejected, and if the number of defective pen sets in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE I.—*Sampling for visual and dimensional inspection AQL (approx.) = 2.5 percent defective*

Lot size	Pen sets in sample	Acceptance (defectives)	Rejection (defectives)
Number	*Number*	*Number*	*Number*
15 and under	3	0	1
16 to 40	7	0	1
41 to 110	15	1	2
111 to 300	35	2	3
301 to 500	50	3	4
501 and over	75	4	5

NOTE.—The Government inspector may institute tightened or reduced inspection in accordance with Section 9 of Military Standard MIL–STD–105.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 *Deterioration (type I).*—Fill the ink reservoir of sample pen set with writing ink conforming to Federal Specification TT–I–563. Allow pen to stand for 1 week at a temperature of 100°F. with pen continuously in socket. Examine pen under low-power microscope for compliance with 3.1.1.

4.3.2 *Non-smear test (type II, class 2) (for blue and black ink).*—The ink shall not smear when rubbed with approximately 2 pounds of pressure of finger or thumb 5 to 8 seconds after writing with blue or black ink used with type II, class 2 ball point pens.

4.3.3 *Non-transferability test (type II, class 2).*—Write several words with type II, class 2 ball point pen samples on one-half of a 5- by 8-inch sheet of writing paper. Approximately 5 seconds after completing the writing, immerse the half of the paper containing the writing in water. Remove and fold in such a manner that the writing will be in contact with the dry half of the paper. Apply gentle pressure over the writing and then unfold the paper. Examine for any transfer of ink.

4.3.4 *Performance tests.*

4.3.4.1 *Type I pen sets.*—Type I pen set, assembled with reservoir filled to 20 percent normal capacity with ink conforming to Federal Specification TT–I–563, shall be subjected to successive temperature changes and examined in accordance with table II.

TABLE II.

Period	Temperature	Examine for—
Hr.	°F.	
2	30	Applicable requirements of 3.4.2
2	70	Overflow and spillage of ink
2	30	Operating efficiency
2	120	Applicable requirements of 3.4.2

4.3.4.2 *Type II pen sets.*—Type II, class 1 pen set with pen filled to normal capacity with fountain pen ink conforming to Federal Specification TT–I–563, shall be subjected to successive temperature changes and examined in accordance with table III.

TABLE III.

Period	Temperature	Examine for—
Hr.	°F.	
2	30	Applicable requirements of 3.5.2
2	70	Leakage after 40° rise in temperature, and performance
2	30	Leakage after 40° fall in temperature, and performance
2	120	Applicable requirements of 3.5.2

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Repeat the foregoing test for type II, class 2 ball point pen set with pen assembled with cartridge supplied therewith.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Civil agencies.

5.1.1 *Packaging.*—Unless otherwise specified, pen sets shall be packaged in accordance with accepted commercial practice.

5.1.2 *Packing.*—Unless otherwise specified, the subject commodity shall be prepared for shipment to permit acceptance by carrier for transportation at the lowest applicable rate, and to afford maximum protection from normal hazards of transportation.

5.1.3 *Marking.*—Unless otherwise specified, marking of packages and shipping containers shall be in accordance with accepted commercial practice.

5.2 Military agencies.

5.2.1 *Preservation and packaging.*

5.2.1.1 *Immediate use (for domestic shipment with immediate use at initial destination).*—Pen sets shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with the manufacturer's commercial practice.

5.2.1.2 *For domestic shipment and storage and overseas shipment.*—Pen sets shall be individually packaged in folding paperboard boxes, set-up boxes, or metal-stayed paperboard boxes conforming to Federal Specification PPP–B–566, PPP–B–676, or Military Specification MIL–B–4229, respectively.

5.2.2 *Packing.*

5.2.2.1 *Immediate use (for domestic shipment with immediate use at initial destination).* — Packages which require overpacking for acceptance by the carrier shall be packed in exterior-type shipping containers in a manner that will insure safe transportation at the lowest rate to the point of delivery. Containers shall meet Consolidated Freight Classification Rules or regulations of other common carriers, as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.2.2.2 *For domestic shipment and storage.*—Pen sets, packaged as described in 5.2.1.2, shall be packed in corrugated or solid fiberboard boxes conforming to Federal Specification LLL–B–631 or LLL–B–636, respectively. The gross weight of fiberboard boxes shall not exceed 70 pounds.

5.2.2.3 *For overseas shipment.*—Pen sets, packaged as described in 5.2.1.2, shall be packed in fiberboard boxes conforming to Military Specification JAN–P–108, compliance symbol V3c or V3s. Boxes shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to Military Specification MIL–L–10547, class 2, and sealed in accordance with the appendix thereto or corners and joints may be sealed by the application of tape conforming to Interim Federal Specification PPP–T–0060 (NAVY–AER). Boxes shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the Appendix to the applicable specification. The gross weight of the box shall not exceed 70 pounds.

5.2.3 *Marking.*—In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, marking for shipment shall be in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.—Desk pen sets covered by this specification are intended for general (not executive) office use in all types of Federal establishments and office installations.

6.2 Ordering data. — Purchasers should specify the type, class, and color of commodity required, require certification as specified in 3.5.1.2, specify whether packaging and packing is for domestic shipment—immediate use, domestic shipment and storage, or overseas shipment, any special marking for shipment, and should exercise any desired options

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offered herein. (See 1.2.1, 1.2.2, 3.1.3, 3.3.1.1, 3.3.3, 3.5.1.2, 3.6, 5.1, and 5.2.)

6.3 Transportation description.—Transportation description applicable to these items is:

Desk pen sets (pens with or without gold or gold-plated points and inkwells or bases).

Carload minimum weight 12,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.

Truckload minimum weight, any quantity.

Patent notice.—When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility, nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise, as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Army—Q
Navy—S MC
Air Force.

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